

SNHU TRAVEL BOUTIQUE PILOT REVIEW

Gilbraith – CS 250 - June 2026

Speaker Notes:

DO:

- 1-2 days Prior to Presentation:
 - Review slide show content.
 - Ensure understanding of materials
 - Practice presentation aloud
 - Ensure you are prepared to speak to any of the points or examples in this presentation including source materials.
- Day of presentation:
 - Arrive at least 15 minutes early to set up
 - Ensure computer equipment is charged and ready to go
 - Ensure screen sharing is ready, and speakers are available as needed

SAY:

Good (morning, afternoon, day or evening) everyone. My name is Kimberly Gilbraith. My job during our recent pilot is what's called a Scrum Master. The

Scrum Master acts as a facilitator and coach who ensures the team understands and follows Scrum principles and practices. Rather than managing people or assigning tasks, they focus on clearing technical or organizational roadblocks so the team can work efficiently and deliver maximum value. Today I am here to review with you a summary of the pilot with Chada Tech's development teams from a traditional waterfall model to an Agile framework using Scrum methodology. Using data and direct experiences from our successful pilot program with the SNHU Travel Boutique application, this presentation details how Scrum methodologies improves collaboration, manages sudden changes, and elevates software delivery speed.

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SCRUM-AGILE ROLES

Roles with a Scrum Team

- Project Owner
- Scrum Master
- Developer
- Tester

(Indeed, 2026)

Speaker Notes:

SAY:

In a traditional waterfall model, corporate teams operate in isolated silos. An Scrum-Agile framework, uses four distinct roles that continually collaborate throughout the project to drive delivery.

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SAY:

The first of these roles in the Product Owner. The Project Owner ensures we build the right thing by managing customer value.

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SAY:

The second role is that of the Scrum Master, this is the role I provided support in for this project. The Scrum Master supports the overall project by clearing out project blocks.

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SAY:

The third role is that of a developer. The role of the developer may differ slightly from what you are familiar with. In a Scrum-Agile environment, instead of a generalized developer pool, technical tracks are highly cross-functional: programmers. The focus directly on writing code and interface design patterns and features.

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The final role within a Scrum team is that of the testers. Our testers build detailed validation scripts simultaneously while development is in progress. This allows them to test and catch issues as they appear.

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SCRUM-AGILE PHASES

Iterative Process Phases

- Requirements and planning
- Design and architecture
- Development and testing
- Deployment and review

(Project Management Institute, 2021)

Speaker Notes:

SAY:

Agile does not remove the Software Development Life Cycle you experience with traditional waterfall models; instead, it changes its flow to short, iterative loops. In a Scum-Agile workflow we look at the overall process and divide it up into manageable pieces. We continually move through Iterative Process Phases throughout the development to ensure a working, and up to date product at the end.

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SAY:

The first phase consists of scoping out the requirements and starting the planning on what is to come. In this beginning phase we break down the requirements in concise user stories that will play a key role in mapping out a

sequence for our work. Every use store is assigned a size and priority to ensure critical work is done first, while ensuring our development team isn't overwhelmed with multiple large requirements at the same time.

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SAY:

The second phase moves into the design and architecture. The team focuses on defining the correct user Interface components, that can be flexible and implemented incrementally. This allows development team members to continually show progress in their work, keeping the flow moving and reducing opportunities for bottlenecks during the project.

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SAY:

The third role phase moves us into development and testing. These two steps run parallel with each other so that as soon as a feature is completed, it moves directly to testing. A typical development cycle, or Sprint, is usually two weeks. This is time for a developer to code their piece and move it to testing for a final update at the end of the cycle.

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SAY:

The final phase is deployment and review. In this phase, previous features completed in sprints are released. This allows customer feedback to be collected and validate the change. If the change isn't something that meets customer needs, this feedback is captured and worked back into the design and current work.

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CONTRASTING WATERFALL AND SCRUM-AGILE WORKFLOWS

- Stakeholder feedback change
- Waterfall solution
 - No backwards movement
 - Rescoping to adapt to change
- Agile solution
 - Short iterative sprints
 - Changes delivered at end of cycle

(Rigby et al., 2020; Slade, 2020)

Speaker Notes:

SAY:

There are several differences between a traditional waterfall workflow and that of the Scrum-Agile workflow. Let's look at an example specific to this project.

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Mid-sprint, our client requested a layout change: moving from a static list layout to an interactive standalone slideshow format. As design expert Tim Slade notes, traditional linear models freeze when unexpected changes occur.

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SAY:

In a traditional waterfall model, there s no backwards pathway to get us from testing or deployment back to the design and development phases. With a waterfall workflow this change would have required rescoping and a new project plan to accommodate this change.

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SAY:

By working within an Agile framework, we were able to pass this information along to all teams during our morning stand-up. As a team we worked through it and shifted our backlog priorities, adjusted our layout parameters, and revised our test scripts to validate the button behaviors smoothly without delaying our final release timeline.

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CHOOSING AN APPROACH

- Fixed environments
 - Legacy systems
 - Unchanging compliance and layouts
- Evolving Environments
 - Fast, collaborative work
 - Multiple stakeholders / SMEs involved
- Stakeholder involvement

(Highsmith, 2021; Milloway, 2019)

Speaker Notes:

SAY:

When deciding on a corporate development framework, leadership must carefully balance structural requirements against project complexity and market volatility. While traditional linear pipelines excel under highly static project rules, dynamic environments require a distinct approach to engineering execution and risk mitigation. By establishing a clear set of strategic criteria, Chada Tech can maximize engineering efficiency while ensuring total project success.

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SAY:

A waterfall model may be a good choice for a highly structured, unchangeable project. This may also be referred to a fixed environment. Examples of this include legacy systems where no unknowns exist and pathways are predictable. Another example could be strict contracts where legal compliance and layouts

offer no room for flexibility or chases.

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SAY:

However, Agile workflows seem to be the way of the future. Industry leaders such as Melissa Milloway highlights that modern organizational environments require agile learning and fast, collaborative discovery paths with our subject matter experts to build trust. Our pilot demonstrated that utilizing a Scrum-Agile workflow minimized delivery risk and optimized development timelines. Agile workflows are best utilized in environment where fast, collaborative work is required. This is usually the case when information is spread out over multiple stakeholders and SMEs.

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Another aspect to consider when deciding which approach to take is your Stakeholder availability and their desired frequency of feedback. A waterfall approach is best suited for stakeholders who prefer to sign off on a finalized requirements document upfront and review the product only at final delivery. Conversely, an Agile methodology requires continuous, active stakeholder engagement throughout the project lifecycle to refine user stories, review frequent software increments, and collaborate on rapid design pivots.

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REFERENCES AND ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

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Speaker Notes:

SAY:

Thank you for your time. Are there any questions?

DO:

- Allow time for questions and answers.